Seth Welch

Founding Engineer & Engineering Lead

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SUMMARY

Founding engineer and engineering lead with 11+ years building full-stack products from zero to scale. Currently founding engineer at Ascension, leading the SOC 2 program and daily engineering operations, and founder of Vesta Shops, a multi-location inventory and point-of-sale platform. Strongest where architecture, security and team leadership meet.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer · Vesta Shops LLC

Aug 2026 – Present

- Founded and built a multi-location inventory and point-of-sale SaaS platform: React, TypeScript, Node.js (Fastify) and PostgreSQL.
- Designed an append-only inventory system so that changes do not mean lost data. Every change is traceable.
- Built a shared till basket that syncs between a phone scanner and the counter and keeps working through connection drops.
- Added stocktakes (taking inventory) with reporting, inter-store inventory transfers, card and cash checkout, and an internal calendar system for tracking shipments and schedules.

Founding Engineer · Ascension

Jan 2025 – Present

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

- Led the company's second consecutive SOC 2 Type II audit to successful completion with zero major findings.
- Lead the company's SOC 2 compliance program: vulnerability management, penetration testing, vendor risk assessments, and continuous Vanta monitoring.
- One of two engineers who built the company's infrastructure and security architecture: encryption at rest and in transit, MFA enforcement, Redis-backed sessions, and role-based access control.
- Own the company's security checks and serve as the point of contact for penetration testers and SOC 2 compliance partners.

ENGINEERING

- Designed and built the full application stack from scratch: React and Tailwind frontend, Node.js and TypeORM backend, PostgreSQL database.
- Engineered domain-specific calculation engines requiring high accuracy across multiple interdependent variables.
- Built and maintain multiple customer-facing product surfaces, including authenticated application experiences and public-facing tools.

LEADERSHIP & OPERATIONS

- Own the engineering hiring pipeline: first point of contact for candidates, co-organized the technical assessments, run background checks, and handle candidate outreach.
- Lead daily engineering standups, driving prioritization and cross-functional communication using a Kanban workflow.
- Onboard and mentor incoming senior engineers, establishing technical context and development workflows.

Engineering Team Lead · Themis

Jan 2024 – Dec 2024

New York, NY (Remote)

- Led a ground-up rewrite of the frontend, replacing a monolithic, inconsistent codebase with a component-based React and Tailwind architecture.
- Established the company's design system and component library, bringing consistency and reusable patterns across the product.
- Improved site performance by more than 50% through architectural changes and frontend best practices.
- Led daily standups and owned sprint-level prioritization; primary liaison between engineering, product, and design.
- Held biweekly one-on-ones with direct reports, supporting individual growth and team health.

Founding Engineer · Stage

Jan 2022 – Dec 2023

San Francisco, CA (Remote)

- One of five engineers working directly with two C-level founders; built the first version of a SaaS platform letting businesses control and monetize features within their own sites, shipped to two paying customers.
- Owned the full stack: React frontend, Kotlin backend, and PostgreSQL schema design and migrations.
- Participated in core architectural decisions and worked with the designer in Figma on an experience built for non-technical business users.

SoFi

May 2015 – Jan 2022

Helena, MT (Hybrid, then Remote)

Senior Software Engineer — Oct 2019 – Jan 2022

Software Engineer — May 2015 – Oct 2019

Technical Trainer (concurrent) — Sep 2017 – Oct 2018

- Led the frontend rewrite of an internal application, replacing a JavaScript and Pug frontend with React and Redux on the existing backend.
- Built internal tooling and developer-productivity software across Node.js, React, Redux, Postgres, Kubernetes, and ActiveMQ.
- Worked with the Communications team on a Live Chat solution and Kafka integration across Java, Spring Boot, PHP, and MySQL.
- Interviewed senior and staff-level engineering candidates and gave hiring recommendations; mentored junior engineers through guidance and code reviews.
- As Technical Trainer, expanded first-week onboarding (Kafka, logging, SBT, Gradle, Git, coding standards) and created a second-week full-stack program for new engineers.
- Organized knowledge-sharing sessions for all engineers and selected the secure programming training program.

SKILLS

Leadership: team leadership, hiring and interviewing, mentoring, technical training, cross-functional delivery

Security & compliance: SOC 2 Type II, Vanta, vulnerability management, penetration testing, vendor risk, RBAC, MFA

Frontend: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Tailwind, design systems, Figma

Backend & data: Node.js, TypeORM, Kotlin, Java, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Kafka, Kubernetes

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science — The University of Montana, Missoula, MT — May 2015